

An honest ETA, not a faster one

What Blinkit's recent 1★–2★ reviews say about delivery time, compared with Zepto and Instamart, and one idea.

LATE DELIVERY

17%

of specific complaints, the highest of the three apps over the same eight days

OF THOSE

1 in 3

compare it with the time the app showed: "shows 10 min", then 25

WHAT'S WORKING

23%

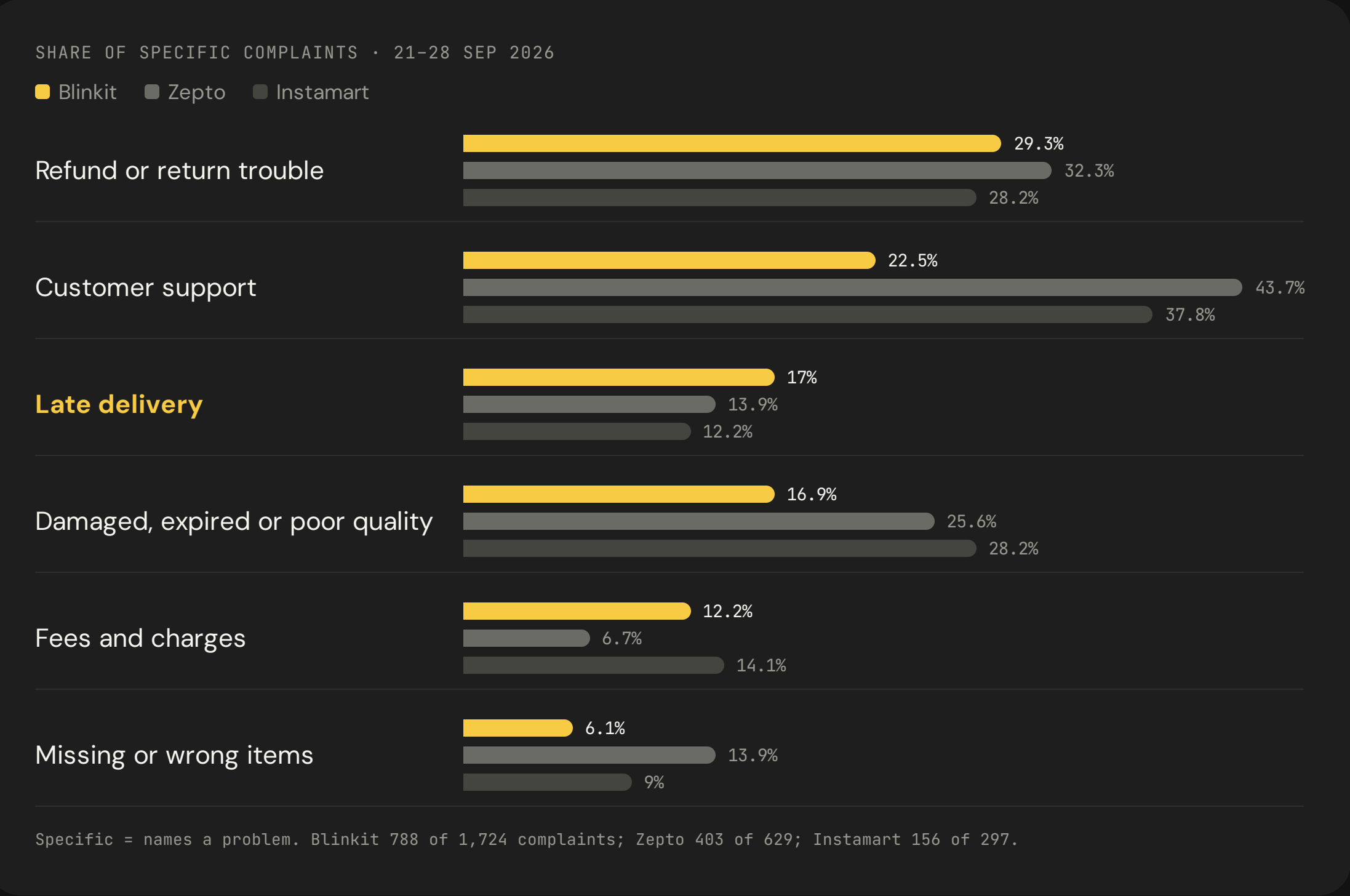
of specific complaints mention support, against 38–44% at the other two

BY

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Late delivery is where Blinkit trails; support is where it leads



LATE DELIVERY

134 of 788

specific Blinkit complaints are about late delivery: 17%, against 14% at Zepto and 12% at Instamart

WHAT'S WORKING

23% vs 44%

Far fewer complaints about support than Zepto (and 38% at Instamart). When something goes wrong, customers mostly get help.

The complaint isn't speed. It's the gap between the time shown and the time it took

SHOWN 10 min

→

ARRIVED 25 min

“it takes too much time times shows 10 min and after that order will be received in 25 min”

1★

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27 Sep 2026

SHOWN 15 min

→

ARRIVED 30-40 min

“Time Not true because 15 minutes delivery time show order time but orginal delivery time 30-40 minutes.”

1★

•

27 Sep 2026

SHOWN “slightly delayed”

→

ARRIVED 20-30 min late

“always showing slightly delay but 20-30 delay always”

1★

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26 Sep 2026

IN THE LATE-DELIVERY COMPLAINTS

45 of 134

compare the delivery time with the time the app showed

CONTEXT • JANUARY 2026

Blinkit dropped its “10-minute delivery” claim after talks with the Labour Ministry about delivery-worker safety. So the fix shouldn't be faster riders. It should be a time customers can trust.

Onmanorama, 13 Jan 2026

Make the time on screen the time at the door

01

A range, not a single number

“Arriving in 12–18 min”, from live store load and rider distance, instead of one optimistic figure.

02

Update the moment it slips

If the ETA moves by more than 5 minutes, tell the customer why and show the new time, before they ask.

03

A free exit when the ETA breaks

If the order runs well past the first time shown and hasn’t left the store, let the customer cancel at no cost.

04

Reward accuracy, not speed

Judge stores and routing on how often orders arrive within the time shown, never on raw minutes.

HOW I’D KNOW IT WORKED

Share of orders delivered within the first time shown, every week, by store.

GUARDRAIL

Order cancellations don’t rise when ETAs become ranges.

WHAT I CAN’T SEE

How Blinkit calculates ETAs today, or store-level data. Some of this may already exist; treat these as starting points.